

As I shared in the introduction, there are now almost eleven million millionaires in America.¹ That's eleven million people who've proved it is possible to build real wealth in this country. These folks didn't buy into the lie that to become a millionaire themselves they needed to come from a wealthy family or inherit a bunch of money. They rejected the voices that said it couldn't be done, and they made it happen. That's great news for you, for me, for all of us! You don't need a rich family. You aren't out there against impossible odds. Eleven million people have gone before you, blazing a trail and busting the myths and lies that want to hold you back. This is a race you can win.

And, by the way, when you get there, don't apologize for winning. Don't feel bad about your success; enjoy it! Too many people are afraid of building wealth. They act like they don't deserve it and feel guilty for achieving more than someone else. That kind of false guilt is a foreign concept to most millionaires who fought their way to the top through hard work and sacrifice. You see, the millionaires we studied believe something that many people today would find revolutionary: they unapologetically believe winning is better than losing. They aren't ashamed of their success. In all the interviews our team conducted, we didn't find anyone who apologized for building wealth. In fact, they were all proud of themselves—and they should be. They've done an incredible job building fortunes that will not only change their lives but also change several generations of their families. That's definitely what I call winning.

Winning is never a bad thing. Everyone would admit they want to win, and nobody would say they would prefer to lose. When my sons were younger, Brock—the most competitive of the bunch—came off the football field with his head down. His team had just lost 55 to 10, and it hurt. He spent the whole drive home in silence. When we got home, he got out and walked up to his room. Ten minutes later, this kid still hadn't said a word. I'll usually give my boys ten minutes or so to pout, but after that, it's time to talk. So I went up to his room, trying to give him some comfort but also making sure he wasn't being a sore loser. Finally, he looked up at me and said, "Daddy, I think I *hate* losing more than I *love* winning."

The weight of that statement pressed down on me over the next several days. I realized I felt the exact same way. I hate to lose. I want to win. I